

Surrealism

From 1924 in Paris, poet André Breton (1896–1966) and a small group of writers and artists decided that real truths and feelings could be uncovered through dreams and the subconscious mind, rather than by logical thinking and planning. Influenced by Sigmund Freud (1856–1939), particularly his 1900 book, *The Interpretation of Dreams*, Surrealist writers and artists believed that the conscious mind repressed the imagination.

In 1924, Breton wrote and published the *Surrealist Manifesto*, proposing that artists and writers should access their unconscious to unleash their imaginations. Artists experimented with methods and ideas to release their underlying feelings and thoughts. Max Ernst (1891–1976) for instance, used mechanical techniques to stimulate his imagination, including frottage and collage, Salvador Dalí and René Magritte painted realistic, dreamlike imagery, and artists such as Miró and André Masson (1896–1987) used automatism to express their unconscious thoughts.



Ernst, *Pleiades*, 1921